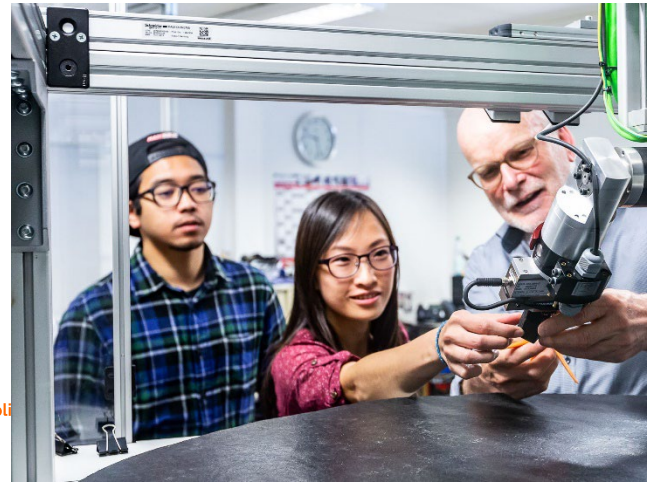
Welcome to orientation programme for international students at THWS

Organised by

Technical University of Applied Sciences
Würzburg-Schweinfurt



Housing („Wohnung“)

Content

1. Moving in
2. Staying in a flat
3. Moving out

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Moving in

➢**Rental contract (“Mietvertrag”)**

- Read terms and conditions
- Deposit (“Kaution”) = 2 or 3 basic monthly rent
- Termination of the rental contract (“Kündigung”)

Moving in

➢ **Rental contract ("Mietvertrag")**

Basic rent („Kaltmiete") + **Additional costs („Nebenkosten")** + **Other**

- Garbage
- Cleaning the stairs
- housekeeper
- Lift
- Water

- Water
- Electricity
- Heating

Moving in

➢**Rental contract ("Mietvertrag")**

- Clarify any doubts about the agreement with the landlord
- Record any changes in the rent contract
- Prior problems:
  - Signing contract without reading it
  - Unaware of which costs are included in the rent and which are not
  - Paying fees if the rent is delayed

Moving in

On the private market

In many cases, if electricity and heating costs are **not included** in the rent (regular case)

- You must register at municipal utilities company „Stadtwerke“
- You will make **monthly estimated advanced payment** („Abschlagzahlung“)

The REAL energy consumption will be calculated at the end of the year or when you move out:

- less consume => refund
- more consume => payment for additional usage above estimated monthly consumtion)

This prodedure applies for the student dorms!!! Students pay an estimated amount and have to pay the difference after the calculation.

Moving in

➢Transfer Protocol ("Übergabeprotokoll")

- For inspection of the condition of the property
- Lists all rental items + Record of damages
- Landlord and tenant have to sign it.
- Submit the transfer protocol to the "Hausmeister" or landlord **within 7 days after arrival.**
- All damages after signing the protocol are at the expense of the tenant.

Wohnungsübergabe-Protokoll
für den Ein- und Auszug

Name der/des Mieter(s): _____

Besichtigte Wohnung, Adresse: _____

vor dem Einzug ☐ vor dem Auszug ☐

Bei der Besichtigung der Wohnung am _____ wurden ☐ keine ☐ folgende Mängel festgestellt:

	In Ordnung	Folgende Mängel wurden festgestellt:	Bemerkungen:
1. Diele/Flur	ja		
2. Küche	ja		
3. Bad/WC	ja		
4. Wohnzimmer	ja		
5. Balkon	ja		
6. Schlafzimmer	ja		
7. Kinderzimmer	ja		
8. Keller	ja		
9. Weitere Räume	ja		
10. Garage	ja		

Strom Zählernummer: ..... Stand: .....

Gas (soweit vorhanden) Zählernummer: ..... Stand: .....

Wasser (soweit vorhanden) Zählernummer: ..... Stand: .....

Bemerkungen - Sonstiges: _____

Es wurden _____ Wohnungsschlüssel übergeben. Es fehlen noch _____ Wohnungsschlüssel.

Letzte Renovierung: _____

Datum: _____ Vermieter: _____
(Unterschrift)

Mieter: _____
(Unterschrift)

Moving in

- **Private apartments**

  Electricity and Water meters (“Zähler”)

  → Record the numbers on the meters in the transfer protocol

Moving in

- Say “Hallo” to the neighbours

Housing („Wohnung“)

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Staying in a flat

➢**Obligations of the tenant**:

- Keep it clean!
- Observe quiet hours (10PM till 7AM).
- Pay for damages/ loosing the key (liability insutrance can help).
- Report damages to the landlord/ Hausmeister.
- Pay the rent.

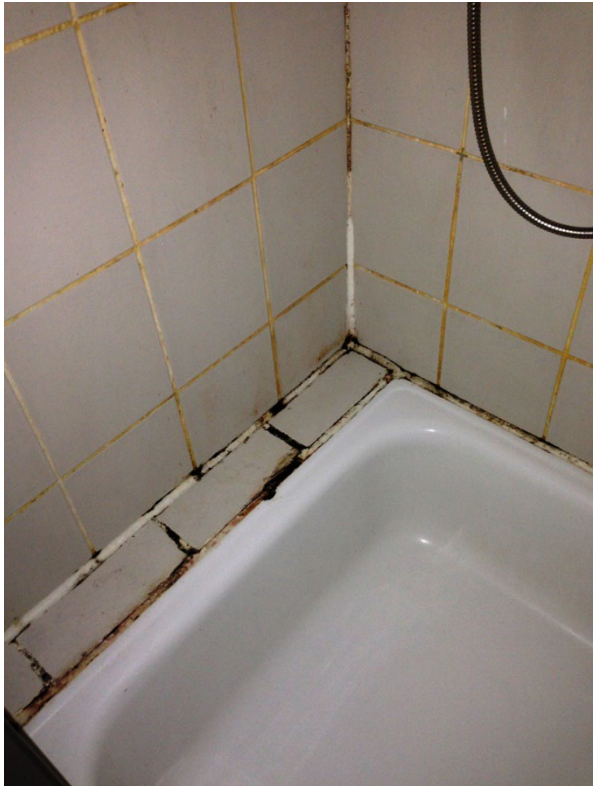
Obligation of the tenant to clean the room/ appartment!

Problematic matters: Maintenance

- Smoking in rooms or stairwell is strictly **forbidden**.
- Clean at least once a week.
- Wipe the floor wet (problems: deep fryer on the floor, sticky floor).
- Clean the kitchen and the bath room.
- **Dry** the bathroom's floor and ventilate the room after ever shower.

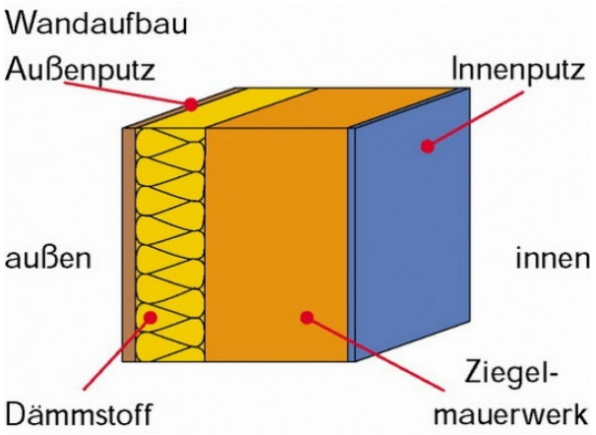
=> otherwise: mold!

Problematic matter: Mold



Problematic matter: Mold

- **Probable causes:**
  - German building construction style (sealed windows, double glazing)
  - No adequate air circulation in winter
  - Humidity in the bath room or kitchen
  - Hanging clothes to dry in the room
    - hang wash in drying rooms/cellar/ balcony



Problematic matter: Mold

Tilting windows in the winter is not recommended

Prevention

- **Ventilate:** Open window widely for 5-15 minutes few times a day.
- Keep aware of the problem with the mold.
- Inform the Hausmeister/landlord.

Problematic matter: Mold

- **Prevention**
  - Dry the bath room floor after every shower.
  - Use a **shower curtain.**
  - Buy a **cleaning agent** against mold (“Schimmelentferner”, be carefully not to breathe it).

Problematic matter:
High electricity and heating costs

- **High electricity and gas costs in Germany**

  Costs: around 37,17 Ct. per kWh

Problematic matter:
High electricity and heating costs

Email from a student on February 26, 2024:

“Recently, we, fours students, received an electricity and gas bill from Stadtwerk amounting to 5200 euros for the four months (1st January 2023 to 30th April 2023) we lived in that apartment.
Given our limited usage of gas and electricity during this period, we find the amount to be exorbitant and disproportionate to our consumption. We are seeking legal advice to understand our rights and options in addressing this matter.“

Problematic matter: Electricity costs

Refrigerator

- Opening the fridge frequently => more electricity use.
- Old fridges consume more energy.
- Damaged rubber seals let the cold/energy out.

Staying in a flat

➢**Ways to save energy**

- Use less heating overnight
- Use extention cords with power switch
- Switch off the router or computer for long periods of absence
- Cook with a lid on the pot (**three time less** electricity consumption)
- Turn off the oven/cooker a few minutes before the end of the cooking time

Staying in a flat

➢**Ways to save energy**

- Do not leave curtains and towels on the heating radiator. Thermostats should not be covered, because they cannot measure the real room temperature
- Old heaters should be checked by a specialist

Use the shutters overnight

=> Less heat output

Staying in a flat

- **Ideal room temperatures**

  Living room: 20-22 C

  Sleeping room: 18 C

  Kitchen: 18-19 C

  Bathroom: 23 C

➢ **German dress style indoor in the winter**

Staying in a flat

➢ Waste separation

- In separate containers:

  Yellow bag: plastic garbage (no food or glass)

  Ask the landlord for yellow bags

  Blue: clean paper

  Black: residual waste („Restmüll“)

  Brown: organic garbage

  Glass (container not directly next to the house)

  Others (electronical devices, batteries, used clothing ect.)

Staying in a flat

➢ Waste separation

- Problems: if food in the yellow bags.

Staying in a flat

➢**Electrical devices**

- Electrical devices do **not belong in** the regular garbage. They have electronic components and traces of poisonous substances
- Bring them to the local recycling depots (Wertstoffhof) or wholesalers.
- Empty batteries: green boxes in some supermarkets or shops

Staying in a flat

➢**Waste separation**

- Environment
- Collect the waste in separate bins at home
- Regularly bring the waste to the respective garbage containers (not after a month)
- Ask the landlord/housekeeper about how to separate and where the containers are kept
- For further information read in internet
- Important from environmental point of view and because of the danger of rats.

Staying in a flat

- **Registration duty at the City hall**
- **Important:** Put your name on the post box and door bell!

=> Otherwise the post will be not delivered!

Staying in a flat

➢ **Paying the rent**

- Recurring payment/Standing order (= Dauerauftrag)

or

- Direct debit (= Lastschriftverfahren for Studentenwerk)

- Bank fee up to 6 Euro if there is insufficient account balance

Staying in a flat

- **Internet**

  Downloading and sharing of films and music is illegal and **STRICTLY forbidden** in Germany !!!

  → Fines starting from 900 or 1.500 euro or more

Staying in a flat

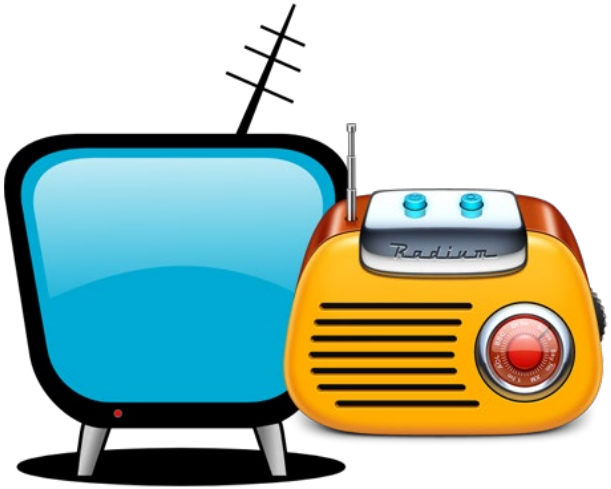
- **Respect**

  For the landlord/landlady and neighbors

Staying in a flat

➢GEZ

- GEZ is the German broadcast fee for public radio, television and internet use
- **18,36 Euro per month** for one household
- Payment every three months
- People sharing apartment share the costs
    - → Divide the amount by the number of people in the flat, but one person should register



Staying in a flat

- **Safety**

  Call **112** for emergencies

  for police (or **110**), ambulance, or fire department.

  Keep the door closed!

  There is no problem with living on the ground floor.

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Moving out

➢**Termination of the rental contract (“Kündigung”)**

- **Submit in written form**
- 2 or 3 months in advance (see in the contract)
- Not acceptable: through sms, What’s App or Facebook
- **Get written confirmation** from the landlord/lady!!!
  (also from sport clubs, phone contract etc.)

Moving out: bad example

Gesendet: Dienstag, 3. September 2019 06:17
An: R. Riedel
Betreff: Termination of Rental Contract

Hi Riedel,

I want to inform you that it is my desire to terminate my rental contract effective on October 1, 2019. As such I will be moving out of the hostel by September 30th, 2019.

Thank you for all the assistance.

Sincerely,

Moving out

Termination of a rental contract: 2-3 months before end of the contract

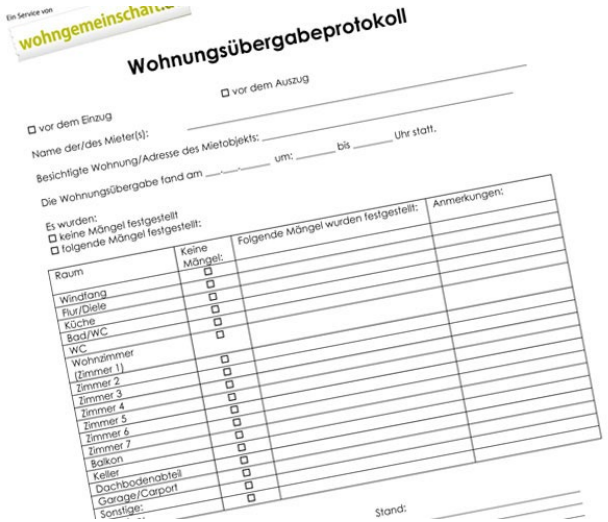
In Studentenwerk:

e. g. Moving on 30. September => submit termination notice **until end of June**

e.g. Moving out on 28. February => submit termination notice **until end of December**

Moving out

- **Before moving out**
  - **Cleaning the room/apartment is the obligation of the tenant!!!**
  - Ask the Hausmeister (supervisor in a student dorm) what and how it should be cleaned.
    - In some cases: painting the apartment (according to the contract)
  - Read and record the electricity/water meter with the landlord
  - Landlord and tenant sign a transfer protocol



Ein Service von wohngemeinschaft

Wohnungsübergabeprotokoll

☐ vor dem Einzug ☐ vor dem Auszug

Name der/des Mieter(s): _____

Besichtigte Wohnung/Adresse des Mietobjekts: _____

Die Wohnungsübergabe fand am ____.____.____ um: _____ bis _____ Uhr statt.

Es wurden:
☐ keine Mängel festgestellt
☐ folgende Mängel festgestellt:

Raum	Keine Mängel:	Folgende Mängel wurden festgestellt:	Anmerkungen:
Windfang	☐		
Flur/Diele	☐		
Küche	☐		
Bad/WC	☐		
WC	☐		
Wohnzimmer (Zimmer 1)	☐		
Zimmer 2	☐		
Zimmer 3	☐		
Zimmer 4	☐		
Zimmer 5	☐		
Zimmer 6	☐		
Zimmer 7	☐		
Balkon	☐		
Keller	☐		
Dachbodenabteil	☐		
Garage/Carport	☐		
Sonstige:	☐		

Stand: _____

Moving out: another bad example

„I am student of THWS bachelor ... who recently moved out from the shared apartment in Schweinfurt to do my internship in another city. My former landlord sent me a picture of a swollen laminate floor saying I have to pay 700 Euro. Moreover he is saying that the painting of the walls, intensive cleaning is required and so on. All of these I have to pay. Otherwise he will go to the court. He is not going to transfer my deposit to me as well of course. “

!! At the moment of moving out and giving back the keys, the landlord and the tenant has to determine if there are some damages and talk about it and write them down in the transfer protocol.

Moving out

Studentenwerk room

- Make an appointment with the janitor (Hausmeister) **14 days** before moving out to determine the day when you will move out

- You have to move out on the last working day before 28.02./31.03. or 30.09. at 10 am. (Not on 1.04./1.10!)

- You will receive a paper for the moving out (Wohnungsgeberberechtigung-Abmeldung)

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Küche	☐		
Bad/WC	☐		
WC	☐		
Wohnzimmer (Zimmer 1)	☐		
Zimmer 2	☐		
Zimmer 3	☐		
Zimmer 4	☐		
Zimmer 5	☐		
Zimmer 6	☐		
Zimmer 7	☐		
Balkon	☐		
Keller	☐		
Dachbodenabteil	☐		
Garage/Carport	☐		
Sonstige:	☐		

Stand: _____

Moving out

➢**Deposit ("Kaution")**

- Covering costs for cleaning and renovation, damages etc.

- The landlord/student dorm has the right to retain part of the deposit until the final calculations for electricity, gas, and water are completed at the end of the year
- Some student dorms or landlords keep a certain amount from the deposit for cleaning costs if the room/apartment is not cleaned well.

Low priced round train tickets from 9am to 3am

- Bayern Hopper ticket:
  -ca.13 euro within 50 km
  -round trip ticket (e.g. from Schweinfurt to Würzburg and back on the same day)
- Bayern ticket: ca.25 Euro + 6 Euro per person, up to 5 people
- Schönes Wochenendticket/weekend ticket: ca.40 Euro + 4 Euro per person in whole Germany, up to 5 people, valid only Saturdays and Sundays:
- Valid only for RE- or RB- trains (not for IC and ICE trains)

Deutschland ticket

- Valid only for RE- or RB- trains (not for IC and ICE trains) and city public transpirtation
- https://www.deutschlandticket-mainfranken.de/
- Possible to by online from 15th of March onwards.

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